Communication Skills

Communication skills means how do we communicate with each other and share our views and thoughts.

Parts of Communication:-
Communication has three important parts:

1) Transmitting: The sender transmits the message through one medium or another.
2) Listening: The reciever listens or understands the message.
3) Feedback: The reciever conveys their understanding of the message to the sender in the form of feedback to complete the communication.

Various elements of a Communication Cycle:
A communication cycle consists of:

Sender: The person beginning the communication.
Message: The information that the sender wants to convey.
Channel: The means by which the information is sent.
Reciever: The person to whom the message is sent.
feedback: The reciever's acknowledgement and response to the message.

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Methods of Communication:

1. Face to face informal communication:- There is nothing better than face to face communication. It helps the message to be understood clearly and quickly. Also, the body language can be seen in this case. It adds to the effectiveness of the communication.

2. E-Mail: E-mail can be used to communicate quickly with one or more individuals in various locations. It offers flexibility, convinience and is low-cost.

Notice / Posters: It is effective when the same message has to go out to a large group of people. Generally used for where E-mail Communication may not be effective. For Example: 'Change in the lunchtime for factory worker'. or 'XYZ Clothing will remain closed for customers on Sunday'.

Business Meetings: Communication during business meetings at an organization are generally adressed to a group of people. It can be related to business, management and organizational decisions.

Other Methods: There can be various other methods like social networks, message, phone, call for communication, newsletter, blog, etc.

VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Verbal communication includes sounds, words, language and speech. Speaking is one of the most effective and commonly used way of communicating.

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Types of Verbal Communication:-

1. Interpersonal Communication:- It takes place between two individuals and is thus a one-on-one conversation.
2. Written Communication:- This form of conversation involves writing words.
3. Small group Communication:- This type of communication takes place when there are more than two people involved.
4. Public Communication:- This type of communication takes place when one individual addresses a large meeting or gathering.

Advantages of Verbal Communication:- It is an easy mode of communication in which you can exchange ideas by saying what you want and get a quick response. Verbal communication also enables you to keep changing your interaction as per the other person's response.

Disadvantages of Verbal communication:
Verbal communication depends on written words, so sometimes the meanings can be confusing and difficult to understand if the right words are not used.

- How to Master Verbal communication:

→ Always think before you speak.
→ Be concise and clear.
→ Confidence and body language is the key.

NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

- Non-verbal communication is the expression or exchange of information or messages without using any spoken or written word.

Importance of Non-verbal communication in our day-to day communication:-

- 55% communication is done using body movements, face, arms, etc.
- 38% communication is done using voice, tone, pauses, etc.
- only 7% communication is done using words.

Non Verbal communication consists of:-

1. Gestures:
   - Raising a hand to greet or say goodbye.
   - Pointing your finger at someone.
2. Expressions:
   - Smiling when you are happy.
   - Making a sad face when you are sad.
3. Body language: Postures by which altitudes and Feelings are communicated.

- Visual Communication:
  - This type of communication proves to be effective since it involves interchanging messages only through images or pictures.
  - Therefore, you don't need to know any particular language for understanding it.

In simpler terms, visual communication is about exchanging information through images.

Example:


→ No phones



→ No entry



→ No parking zone


→ No smoking zone

COMMUNICATION CYCLE AND The importance of Feedback

for effective communication, it's important that the sender recieves an acknowledgement from the reciever about getting the messages across.
While the sender sends information, the recievver provides feedback on the recieved message.

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Types of feedback:-

- Positive feedback
- Negative feedback
- No feedback

* What is a good feedback?
→ A good feedback is one that is :-

1.) Specific i.e, you should avoid general comments and instead try to include examples to clarify your statement.

2.) Timely i.e, feedback should be made on time, since it loses it's impact if delayed for too long.

3.) Polite i.e, the recipent should not feel offended by the language of the feedback.

4.) offering continuing support ie, after offering feedback, let recipents know you are available for support. It should be a continuous process.

Importance of feedback:-

- It validates effective listening between sender and reciever.
- It motivates people to build better work relationships and continue the good work that is being appreciated.
- It boosts learning and is important to remain focussed on goals, plan better and develop improved products and services.
- It improves performance.

Barriers to effective Communication:-

Physical Barriers:- Not being able to see gestures, posture and general body language can make communication less effective. Here environment and natural conditions act as a barrier in communication.

Linguistic Barriers: The inability to communicate using a language is known as language barrier to communication.

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Interpersonal Barriers: It is also very difficult to communicate with someone who is not willing to talk or express their feelings and views. These barriers also occur when the sender's message is recieved differently from how it was intended.

Organisational barriers: Superior-subordinate relationships in a formal organisational structure can be a barrier to free flow of communication.

Cultural barriers: It occurs when people of different cultures are unable to understand each other's customs, resulting in inconviniences and difficulties.

*Ways to Overcome barriers to effective Communication:

- Use simple language
- Do not form assumptions on culture, religion or geography.
- Use visuals.
- Take help of a translator to overcome differences in language.

Be respectful of other's opinions.
Try to communicate in person as much as possible.

Writing Skills - Part of Speech

Writing skills are part of Verbal communication and include e-mails, letters, notes, articles, SMS/chat, blogs etc.

1. Capitalisation :- This is a set of simple rules that help you capitalise words correctly.
   - Titles :- Capitalise the first letter in the titles used before people's names.
   - Word 'I' :- Always capitalise the letter 'I' when it's used as a word (pronoun).
   - Names :- Capitalise the first letter in the names of people, places, days and months. (noun).
   - Starting letter of sentences :- Capitalise the first letter in every sentence.

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2. Punctuation :- It refers to the marks used in writing to clarify meaning and indicate pauses.
   - Punctuation name :- • It's used at the end of sentence.
     • Used with short form of long words.
   - Comma : • Used to indicate a pause in the sentence.
     • Used to seperate two or more items in a row.
   - Question mark : It's used at the end of question.
   - Exclamation mark : Used at the end of a word or a sentence to indicate a strong feeling.
   - Apostrophe : • Used following by an 's' to show possession or belonging.
     • Used with shortened form of words in informal speech.

Basic Parts of Speech:

The part of speech indicates how a particular word functions in meaning as well as grammatically within the sentence.

- Nouns – Names of people, places, animals and things.
- Pronouns – He, She, You, I
- Adjectives – Salty, Spicy, et.c.
- Verbs – Walk, talk, et.c.
- Adverbs – slocoly, quickly et.c.

Supporting parts of speech:-

- Articles – A, an, the
- Conjuctions – And, but, et.c.
- Interjection – Wow, Oh-no, et.c.
- Preposition – In, On, et.c.

WRITING SKILLS - SENTENCES

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Parts of a Sentence:

- Subject: Person or thing that performs an action.
- Verb: Describes the action.
- Object: person or thing that recieves the action.

Types of Sentences:-

1. Statement or Declarative sentence.
2. Question or Interrogative sentence.
3. Emotion/ Reaction or exclamatory sentence.
4. Order or imperative sentence.

Active and Passive sentences:- Sentences where the subject does an action are known to be in the active voice, whereas sentences in which the subject recieves an action are known to be in the Passive voice.

Ex. of Active Sentence: Radha is reading a book.

Passive Sentence: A book is being read by Radha.